Project Report: Student Digital Ambassador

Course: CSE0001 - Digital Literacy

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Branch: B.Tech Electronics and Communication Engineering (ECE)

Batch: 2025–2029

University: VIT Bhopal University

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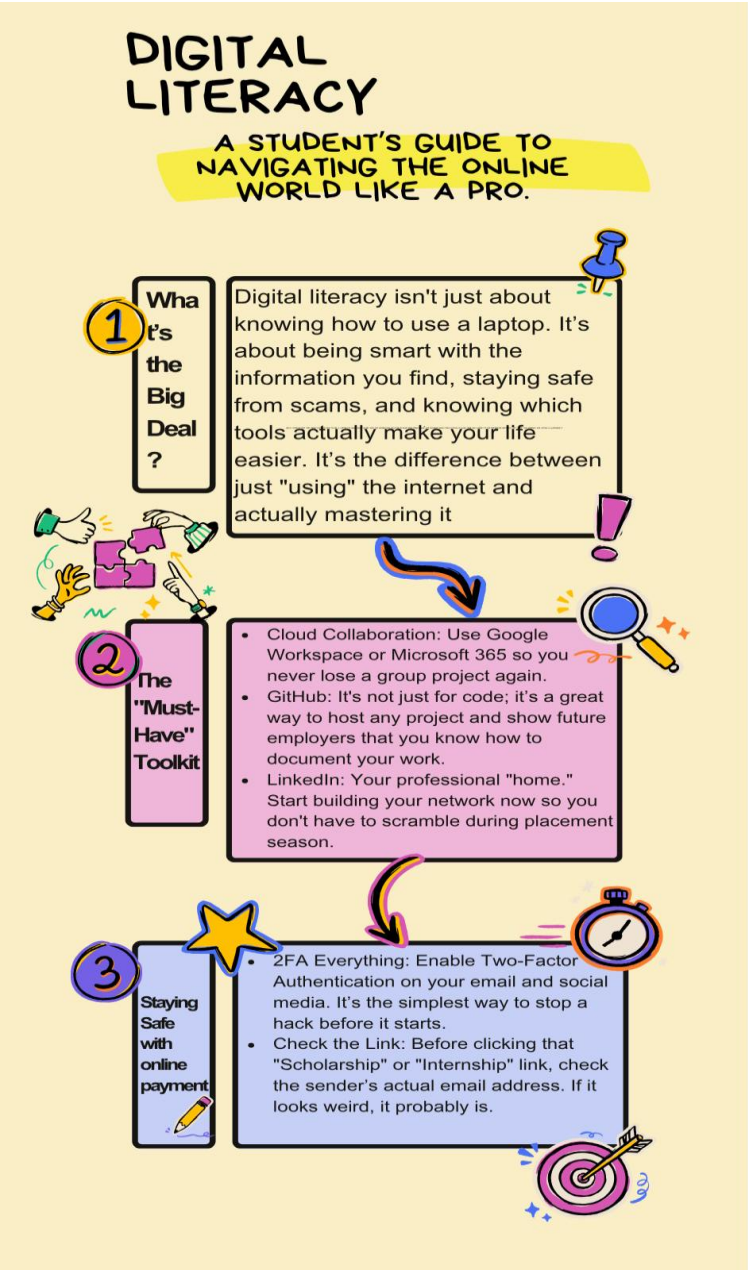
Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used: Canva

Topics Covered: Defining Digital Literacy, Essential Toolkits, and Online Safety.

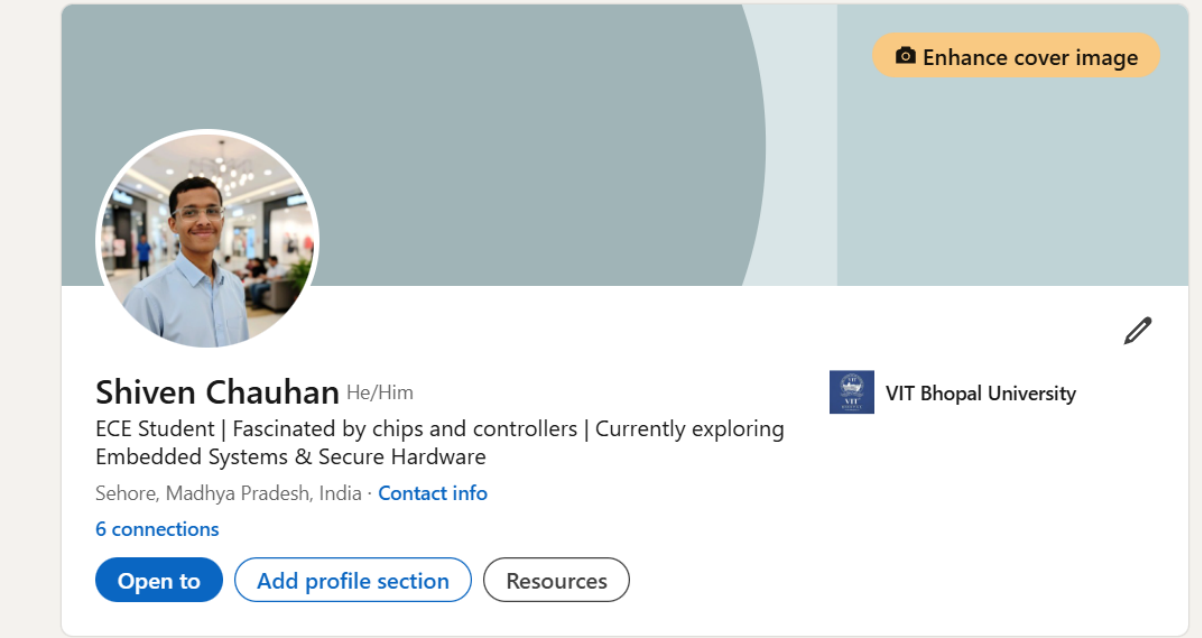


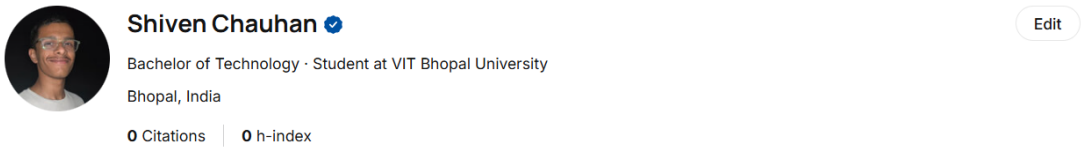
Reflection: For this task, I wanted to create a visual that felt approachable for any student, not just those in technical branches. I designed the infographic titled "Digital Literacy: More Than Just Googling" to highlight that being digitally literate is about mastery, not just usage. I focused on three pillars: the definition of literacy in a university context, the "must-have" tools like GitHub and LinkedIn, and critical safety habits like 2FA and the "UPI PIN Rule."

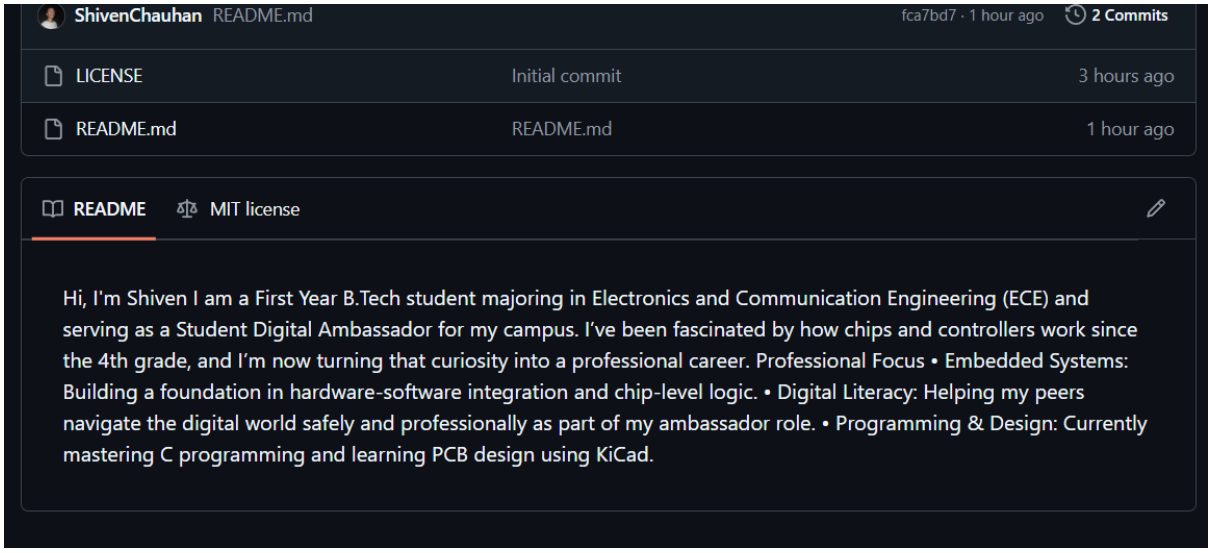
The process taught me that simplifying complex ideas is harder than it looks. I had to be very selective with my wording to ensure the most important safety tips—like checking email headers for phishing—stood out immediately. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I've realized that clear communication is our best defense against the rising number of digital scams. This task helped me bridge the gap between technical knowledge and practical, everyday safety for my peers.

Task 2: Professional Digital Portfolio

Platforms Used: GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate.







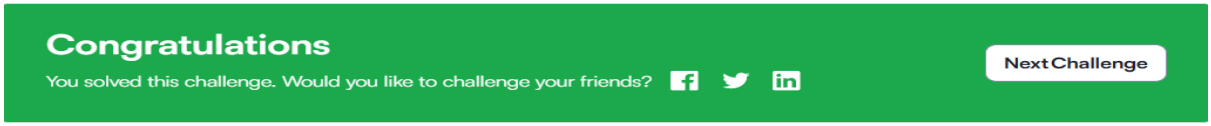
Reflection: Building a professional digital presence is essential for an ECE student looking to enter the industry. I chose GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate to create a balanced portfolio that covers code, networking, and academic research. GitHub is where I host my C programming and circuit design work, providing a "living resume"

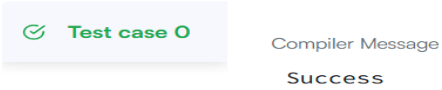
for recruiters to see my actual progress. On LinkedIn, I updated my profile to reflect my current B.Tech status and my specific interests in embedded systems and secure hardware, ensuring I'm visible to the right professional circles.

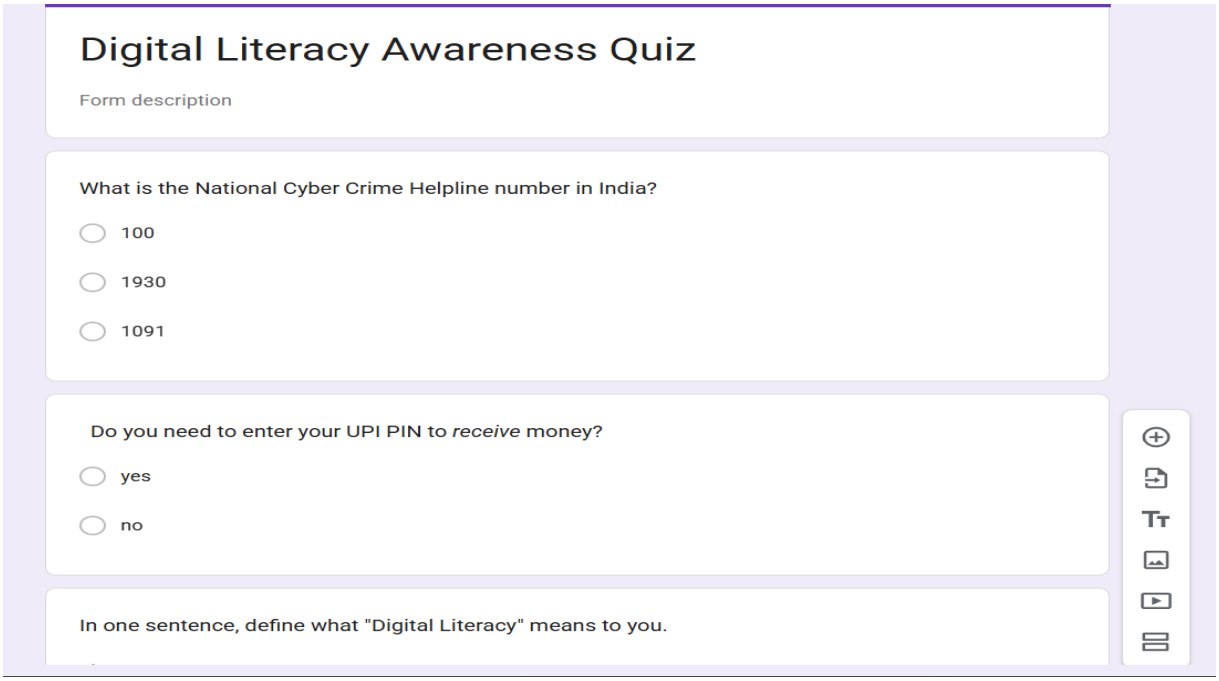
I opted for ResearchGate because I've been fascinated by chips and controllers since the 4th grade, and I want to stay updated on the latest semiconductor research. This platform allows me to follow the work of experts in fields I hope to join one day. These three profiles now work together to show that I am technically capable, professionally connected, and academically curious.

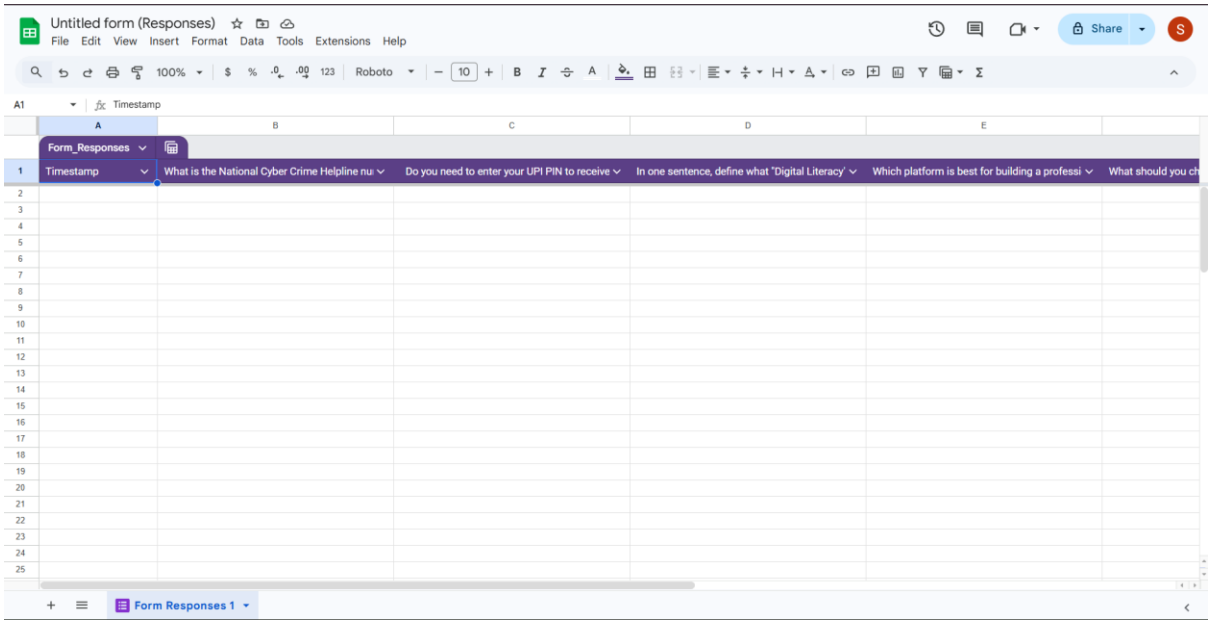
Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Tools Used: HackerRank and Google Forms.









Reflection: This task allowed me to practice the "collaboration" side of digital literacy. I completed a beginner-level coding challenge in Python on HackerRank, which was a great way to see how automated platforms handle logic and syntax testing. Beyond coding, I designed a five-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. This wasn't just about making a quiz; it was about learning how to collect, organize, and analyze data efficiently through a linked Google Sheet.

As a student who spends a lot of time on local coding environments, moving into cloud-based collaboration tools was eye-opening. I realized how much more productive group projects could be if we used these tools properly. This task reinforced the idea that being a "digital ambassador" means being comfortable with the platforms that allow us to work together seamlessly, whether we're debugging a script or gathering feedback from a large group of people.

Task 4: Professional Communication & Etiquette

Deliverables: Extension Request Email, Internship Inquiry Email, and Social Media Checklist.

Email 1: Requesting an Extension

Subject: Extension request: Assignment 240326 - Shiven [25BEC10027]

Hello Sir,

I'm writing to see if it's possible to get a short extension on the Assignment 240326 due this March 24 . I've run into some unexpected technical issues with my laptop setup that have set my progress back a bit.

Would it be alright if I turned it in by 25 March instead? I want to make sure the work is actually up to standard rather than rushing to finish it today.

Thanks for your time and help.

Best,

Shiven Chauhan

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B.Tech ECE, 1st Year

Email 2: Internship Inquiry

Subject: Summer Internship Inquiry - ECE Student

Hi Sir,

My name is Shiven Chauhan, and I'm a first-year ECE student. I've been following the work AMD does with embedded systems for a while, and I'm really interested in the field—especially since I've been working with chips and controllers since I was quite young.

I'm looking for a summer internship where I can put my C programming and circuit design basics to use. I've attached a link to my GitHub portfolio if you'd like to see some of my work.

Let me know if there are any openings or if you need any more info from my side.

Thanks,

Shiven Chauhan

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Reflection: Task 4 was about the "soft skills" of the digital world. I drafted two professional emails—one for a deadline extension and another inquiring about an ECE internship. I also created a social media checklist to ensure my online footprint remains professional and secure. One situation that really stood out to me was a group project where vague messaging led to the team bringing an incomplete physical circuit to a lab. It taught me that being brief is good, but being clear is better.

I've started applying these lessons to my daily life, especially when contacting faculty. I've noticed that using a clear subject line and a respectful tone leads to much faster and more helpful responses. For the social media part, I've become much more careful about what I share publicly and who can see it. It's about building a "digital brand" that I'll be proud of when I graduate in 2029.

Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study & Awareness

Deliverables: UPI Scam Case Study and Prevention Checklist.

Title: The "Reverse-Request" UPI Scam

This case study looks at a common type of online payment fraud that targets college students and young professionals. The scam usually starts when a student lists something for sale on an online marketplace or receives a random call about a "refund" or "scholarship".

The crime follows a specific step-by-step process. First, the attacker contacts the victim, claiming they want to send money via a UPI app like GPay or PhonePe. Instead of sending money, the attacker sends a "Request Money" link. They often pressure the victim to act quickly, saying things like, "I've sent the payment, just click 'Approve' and enter your PIN to receive it." This is where the trap is set—many people forget that you never need to enter your UPI PIN to *receive* money, only to *send* it.

Once the victim enters their PIN, the money is instantly deducted from their bank account and moved through multiple "mule" accounts to make it hard to track. The consequences are often severe; for a student, losing a few thousand rupees can mean losing their entire monthly allowance or semester fees. Even though individual losses might seem small, the scale of these scams is massive, often funding larger criminal networks

Reflection: For the final task, I researched the "Reverse-Request" UPI scam, which is unfortunately common among university students. I found that most cybercrimes succeed not because of a "hack" in the software, but because of a "hack" in human psychology—scammers use urgency and panic to trick people into entering their PINs. This research was a wake-up call for me. Even with my technical background, I realized how easy it is to make a mistake when you're in a hurry.

I've shared the "No PIN to receive" rule with my family and friends, as it's the simplest way to prevent these types of losses. Being a Digital Ambassador has changed how I view my phone; I no longer see it just as a tool for games or study, but as a portal that needs constant protection. This project has given me the confidence to not only stay safe myself but also to help others navigate their digital lives without fear.